

Arturo Bertero

Political Sociologist | Computational Social Scientist

Italian

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EDUCATION

2021 - 2025	Ph.D. in Political Science	Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan (NASP), Italy.
Feb.-Mar. 2024	Virtual Visiting	Michigan State University, Belief Systems Lab; under the supervision of Mark J. Brandt.
2018 - 2020	MA in Political and Public Communication	University of Turin, Department of Culture, Politics and Society, Italy.
2019 - 2020	Erasmus	University of Stockholm, Department of Sociology, Sweden.
2015 - 2018	BA in Social and Political Science	University of Turin, Department of Culture, Politics and Society, Italy.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2025-2027	PostDoc Researcher (<i>"Contratto di ricerca"</i>)	<i>Lonely-EU</i> : Horizon project, UniMi. WP leader: Cristiano Vezzoni.
2024 - 2025	PostDoc Researcher	<i>SUSPECTS</i> : StUdying SuPply, demand, and Endorsement of Conspiracy TheorieS in six European countries. PI: Mancosu, M.
2022	Coding Assistant	Harmonization of ITANES dataset . Activity carried out for SPS Trend group.
2020	Research Assistant	<i>Development of a hate speech dictionary for social media analysis</i> . Research carried out by "CODER" (Center for Public Opinion and Digital Environment Research). With G. Bobba, A. Seddone, M. Mancosu, and F. Vegetti.
2020	Research Assistant	<i>Preparation of an expert survey regarding media populism in Europe</i> . With A. Nai (University of Amsterdam), G. Bobba, A. Seddone, M. Mancosu, F. Vegetti (University of Turin).
2019	Research Assistant	<i>Monitor and mapping of Facebook pages spreading fake news and conspiracy theories</i> . University of Turin, project CODER.
2019	Research Assistant	<i>Participant in the H2020 Project 'DEMOS – Democratic Efficacy and the Varieties of Populism in Europe'</i> .

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2026	Applied Statistics Lab	MA Allievi, Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin. Course "Applied Statistics". Program: RStudio
2025	Applied Statistics Lab	MA Allievi, Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin. Course "Applied Statistics". Program: RStudio
2024	Social and political attitudes	Invited lecture for the class " Social and political attitudes ". Course held by Cristiano Vezzoni; MA DAPS&CO - Data Analytics for Politics, Society & Complex Organizations, UniMi. Lecture title: "Political belief systems as networks of attitudes"
2024	Applied Statistics Lab	MA Allievi, Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin. Course "Applied Statistics", held by Auer, D., Szekely, A., Nalewajko K. Program: STATA
2023	Survey design	Lecture for Pepe Research on survey design and implementation.
2020 - 2021	Political Science 2.0	University of Turin, course held by professor Bobba G. Bachelor in "Social Innovation, Communication, and New Technologies".

PUBLICATIONS

- 2026 **Bertero, A.** (2026). Conspiracy theories are central to the complex system of predictors of Italian vaccine hesitancy. [Italian Political Science](#).
- 2026 **Bertero, A.**, Growiec, K., Luhmann, M., Tang, Y., & Vezzoni, C. (2026, February 7). LONELY-EU WP3_1A: Database of Loneliness Datasets in Europe. [OSF Report](#).
- 2025 Mancosu, M., Vassallo, S., Pedrazzani, A., Belluati, M., Ventura, S., **Bertero, A.**, & Sumbul, U. (2026). SUSPECTS: Supply, Demand, and Communication of Conspiracy Theories in Comparative Perspective. [Italian Political Science](#).
- 2025 **Bertero, A.** Beyond Constraint: Tightness and Consensus of Political Belief Systems. [Accepted for publication at [Italian Political Science Review](#)]
- 2025 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G. (2025). *Consolidation and Change: Exploring the Impact of Anger and Network Dynamics on Inequality Belief Systems*. [Network Science](#)
- 2024 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G. & Mijs, J.J.B. (2024). *Inequality Belief Systems: What They Look Like, How to Study Them, and Why They Matter*. [Social Indicators Research](#).
- 2023 Franetovic, G., & **Bertero, A.** (2023). *How do people understand inequality in Chile? A study through attitude network analysis*. [AWARI](#).
- 2023 **Bertero, A.**, & Scaduto, G. (2023). *A midsummer night's dream: political communication during the Italian 2022 electoral campaign*. [Italian Journal of Electoral Studies OOE-IJES](#).
- 2022 Vegetti, F., **Bertero, A.**, Bobba, G., Mancosu, M., Seddone, A. *Fuel My Fire*. [Blue paper for Unito](#).
- 2021 **Bertero, A.**, & Seddone, A. (2021). *Italy: Populist in the mirror, (De) politicizing the Covid-19 from government and opposition*. In: *Populism and the Politicization of the COVID-19 Crisis in Europe* (pp. 45-58). [Palgrave Macmillan](#).
- 2021 Marincea, A., Školkay, A., Baloge, M., **Bertero, A.**, Bobba, G., Hubé, N., & Sotiropoulos, D. A. (2021). *Populism and Social Media: A comparative analysis of populists' shared content and networks on Facebook*. [DEMOS](#).
- 2021 **Bertero, A.** (2021). *The COVID-19 Related Communication of Italian Politicians and Its Success on Facebook*. In [Current Populism in Europe](#).

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer	Information Communication and Society; Socius; British Journal of Psychology; Italian Political Science; Humanities and Social Sciences Communication, Social Indicators Research, American Journal of Political Science, Political Psychology, Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: Attitudes and Social Cognition
Web developer	EU Loneliness Explorer

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS AND NETWORKS

2023 - present	Member	ECPR standing group on: affective polarization, political sociology, political communication, political methodology, political psychology, and political networks
2022 - present	Member	American Sociological Association.
2022 - present	Informal affiliation	Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin.
2021 - present	Member	SPS Trend Group, University of Milan.
2020 - present	Member	European Consortium for Political Research.

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND RESEARCH GRANTS

2025-2026	<i>PostDoctoral Scholarship ("Contratto di ricerca")</i> . Department of Social and Political Sciences, University la Statale of Milan. LONELY-EU project; P.I.: Cristiano Vezzoni.
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2024-2025	<i>PostDoctoral Scholarship</i> . Department of Culture, Politics, and Society, University of Turin. SUSPECTS project; P.I.: Moreno Mancosu.
2021- 2024	<i>Doctoral Scholarship</i> . Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan.
2021	Award for the best Master thesis of UniTo, University of Turin.
2021	Scholarship Awarded by Collegio Carlo Alberto (Turin). <i>Research assistant</i> to the project “Media Populism, a comparative analysis based on an expert survey”.
2021	“ <i>Culture della Materia</i> ” in Public Opinion and Political Communication.
2020	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> of Professor Bobba G., University of Turin, Department of Culture, Politics and Society.

ACADEMIC SCHOOLS

2025	<i>Behave Summer School on Agent-Based Modelling 2025</i> . University of Milan
2025	<i>Doing Computational Social Science with Python and R</i> . University of Milan
2024	AI-GENIE : Automatic Item Development and Validation using LLMs. Statistical Horizons, by Hudson Golino.
2023	Multilevel Models with R. By LEMMA, Learning environment for multilevel methodology and applications, University of Bristol.
2023	Egocentric network analysis with R. By Raffaele Vacca.
2023	NASP-CCA DAYS 2023: Frontiers of Methods in Social and Political Science. Event organized by NASP, and hosted by Collegio Carlo Alberto.
2023	Psychological Networks Amsterdam Winter School 2023, University of Amsterdam
2022	NASP-CCA DAYS 2022: Frontiers of Methods in Social and Political Science. Event organized by NASP, and hosted by Collegio Carlo Alberto.
2021	NASP CCA DAYS 2021: Frontiers of Methods in Social and Political Sciences. Event organized by NASP, and hosted by Collegio Carlo Alberto.
2020	Course in <i>Quantitative Text Analysis</i> , held by F. Vegetti. Advanced course related to the excellence project “CODER” (Center for Public Opinion and Digital Environment Research)

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

2026	Bertero, A. , Marolla, F., Vezzoni, C, “Disconnected Citizens: Social Isolation, Loneliness, and Voter Turnout in Europe”. LONELY-EU ambassador meeting.
2026	Bertero, A. , Marolla, F., Vezzoni, C, “Disconnected Citizens: Social Isolation, Loneliness, and Voter Turnout in Europe”. LONELY-EU internal seminar.
2025	Bertero, A. , Mancosu, M., & Vegetti, F., “Measuring Belief in Conspiracy Theories Across Borders: A Cross-National Psychometric Approach”. <i>ISPP, Prague</i>
2025	Mancosu, M., Bertero, A. , Vegetti, F. “Those who know the most are not always the least deceived; on the concept and measurement of conspiracist knowledge”. <i>ComPol, Milan</i>
2025	Bertero, A. , “Beliefs in conspiracy theories, conspiracist mentality, and political ideology: a comparative approach”. <i>Salzburg, Department of Political Science, Invited presentation.</i>
2024	Bertero, A. , “Belief systems as networks of attitudes: conceptualization and implications”. <i>INSNA Sunbelt, Edinburgh.</i>
2024	Bertero, A. , “Belief systems as networks of attitudes: conceptualization and implications”. <i>Bicocca University, invited by Giulio Costantini.</i>
2024	Bertero, A. , “The political belief systems of Italian voters”. <i>Behave Rendez-vous, Milan</i>
2023	Bertero, A. , Franetovic, G., “Modelling, estimating, simulating: formalizing attitudes towards inequality as a complex network”. <i>EUSN conference, Ljubjana.</i>
2023	Bertero, A. , Franetovic, G., “Overcoming the structuralist/individualist dichotomy: Inequality beliefs from a new network and comparative perspective”. <i>ESRA conference, Milan.</i>
2023	Bertero, A. , “Conspiracy theories are central to the complex system of predictors of Italian vaccine hesitancy”. <i>CCA Days 2023.</i>
2023	Bertero, A. , Franetovic, G., “Modelling, estimating, simulating: formalizing attitudes towards inequality as a complex network”. <i>CCA Days 2023.</i>
2023	Bertero, A. , Franetovic, G., “Modelling, estimating, simulating: formalizing attitudes towards inequality as a complex network”. <i>ECPR Toulouse.</i>
2023	Franetovic, G., Bertero, A. , “¿Cómo las personas entienden la desigualdad en Chile?: Un estudio de actitudes mediante análisis de redes”. <i>CHISOCNET.</i>

- 2023 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G., “Modelling, estimating, simulating: formalizing attitudes towards inequality as a complex network”. *SISEC Conference, Brescia*.
- 2022 Franetovic, G., **Bertero, A.**, “Overcoming the structuralist/individualist dichotomy: Inequality beliefs from a new network and comparative perspective”. *1st ISSP User Conference on Social Inequality*.
- 2022 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G., Moroni, M. & Saccomanno, P. “Trust in science and risk perception: studying the adoption of anti-contagion behaviors in Italy during the COVID-19 pandemic”. *ResPOnsE COVID-19 Workshop*. Two years of COVID-19 in Italy: Values, attitudes, and behaviours in the pandemic period 2020-21 (Milan, Italy).
- 2022 **Bertero, A.**, Rosco, J., & Saccomanno, P. “Testing the theory of Affective Intelligence”. *ResPOnsE COVID-19 Workshop*. Two years of COVID-19 in Italy: Values, attitudes, and behaviors in the pandemic period 2020-21 (Milan, Italy).
- 2021 Vegetti F., **Bertero A.**, Bobba G., Mancosu M., Seddone A. Populist language, issues, and the success of party communication on Facebook. Presented at the *6th Prague Populism Conference*.
- 2021 **Bertero A.**, Bobba G., Mancosu M., Nai A., Seddone A., Vegetti F. Measuring media populism through a comparative expert survey: a first assessment. *ECPR, Section S45: “Political Communication in Times of Crisis”*.
- 2021 Vegetti F., Bobba G., Mancosu M., Seddone A., **Bertero A.** Così fan tutti? L’incivility nei commenti alle pagine politiche su Facebook. Presented at *SISP*.
- 2020 **Bertero A.**, The COVID-related communication of populist leaders and its engagement on social media. Presented at the *DEMOS online workshop H2020*.

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Languages	Native Fluent	Italian English
Software and Programs	RStudio, Rmarkdown , Stata, SPSS Statistics, Excel, Word, GitHub, NVivo, NetLogo, TeXstudio, PowerPoint, Zotero, Overleaf, Pajek, Python, Shiny .	
Research Methods	Agent-Based Modelling, AI-GENIE (AI for Scale Validation) , Correlational Class Analysis, Egocentric Network Analysis , Exploratory Graph Analysis, Expert Surveys, Factor Analysis, In-depth Interviews, Item Response Theory, Latent Class Analysis, Latent Profile Analysis, Multilevel Modeling, Psychological Networks , Quantitative Analysis, Regression Analysis, Research Design, Structural Equation Modeling , Survey Experiment, Survey Research .	